

1. Introduction: 300 words $\pm 10\%$ (270 – 330 words)

The housing environment is an essential factor related to the quality of life for the public. In Australia, there are a significant number of challenges in remote indigenous-majority regions, including high housing costs, low ownership rate and overcrowding. Social and economic inequality between regions can occur because of these housing challenges. Furthermore, vulnerable housing environment can affect both psychological and physical health problems. For instance, overcrowding might lead to health problems, such as skin infections, respiratory condition issues and ear infections from a health perspective (Memmott et al., 2022, p. 271). Therefore, governments have an obligation to manage housing stability, enhancing both housing affordability and accessibility.

This report has been written to analyse the current housing situations and challenges based on the data provided by Australian Bureau of Statistic (ABS) and provide suggestions for policy practice research to improve housing equity between urban regions and remote regions. Higher housing costs compared to median household incomes have been considered a major challenge in this report. That is why this problem can influence the deterioration of other challenges, such as overcrowding by higher housing cost. The datasets are mainly analysed for providing information about the comparison of median household incomes and employment rates by regions according to the degree of remoteness. Moreover, the trend of rental fees in indigenous regions over years. The primary categorisation is based on remoteness area, which is classified into five categories by Australian Statistical Geography Standard (ASGS), including major cities, inner region, outer region, remote and very remote region.

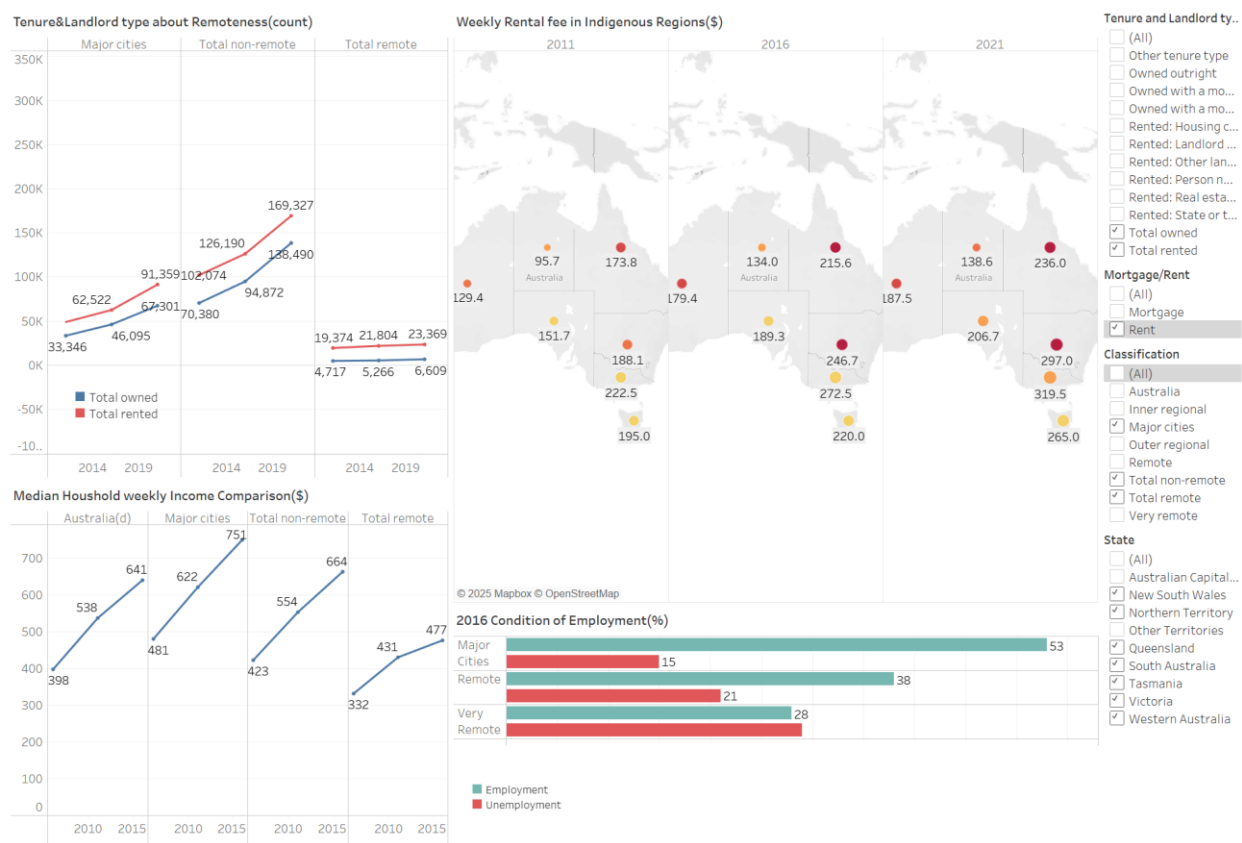
This report will firstly illustrate the current trends related to housing costs in remote indigenous regions utilising a dashboard consisting of line graphs, a map graph, and bar graph. It then states the importance of anticipated challenges by higher housing costs. Finally, recommendations are suggested for policy research to help guide more equitable housing policies.

2. Background: 400 words $\pm 10\%$ (360 – 440 words)

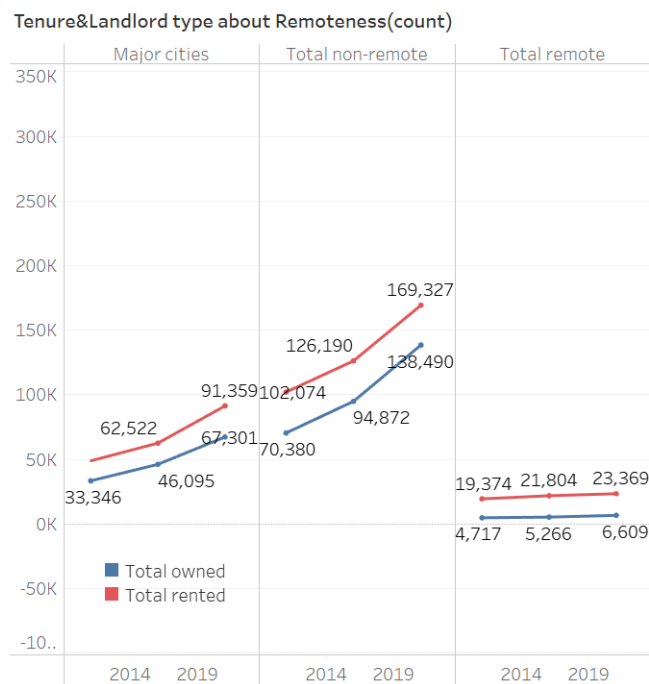
2.1. housing challenge

There is a correlation between higher housing price and other challenges. Higher housing prices may increase cost burden in households. This situation can also influence overcrowding because multiple residents want to share housing costs for one house to reduce cost burden. Such situation can negatively affect affordability by living in the inadequate and vulnerable environment. In terms of housing accessibility, housing costs should be adjusted to the appropriate level of cost. Higher housing cost can lead to widening the wealth gap. Therefore, higher housing cost issue should be solved.

2.2. Analysis of data



This dashboard has explained the increase in cost burden of households living in remote regions, showing trend of rental fee, household income and unemployment rate.



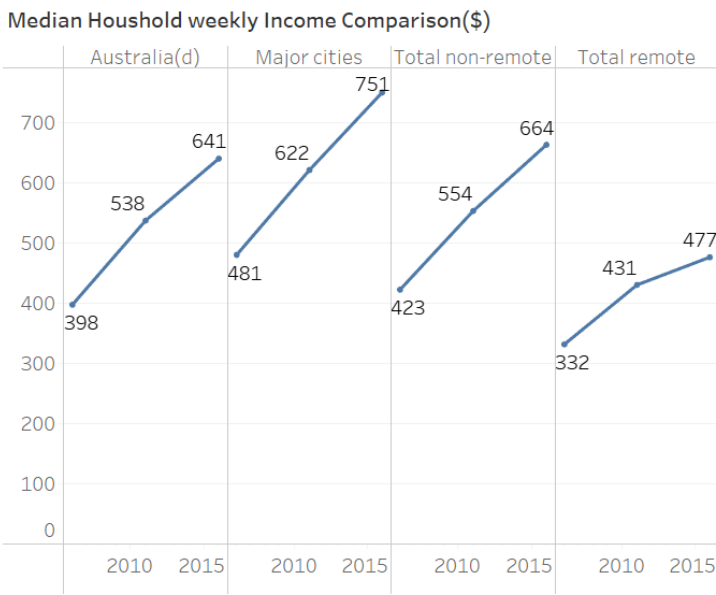
<graph1>

According to graph 1 (ABS, 2022), rent has been preferred to ownership about housing in both non-remote regions and remote regions. That is why rental fee is focused in this report. However, the number of rent and ownership in remote regions (23,369) has been much smaller than that of non-remote area (169,327). The increased count of remote areas (1,565) about rent also shows lower than that of non-remote regions (43,137).

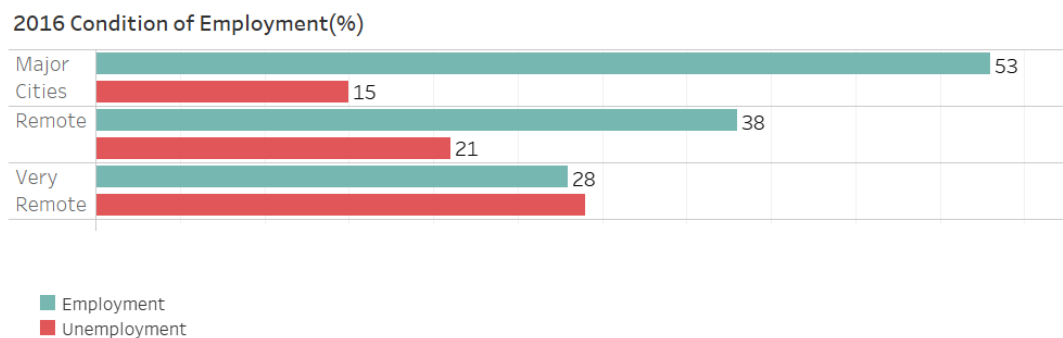


<graph2>

The steady increasing rental fees in indigenous regions between 2011 and 2021 can be shown in graph 2 (ABS, 2022). In 2011, rental fee in most regions was approximately \$100 to \$150, whereas in 2021, rental fee has been shown around \$250.



<graph3>



<graph4>

Overall median household weekly incomes have also increased, but household income of total remote areas (\$477) appears to be much lower than that of non-remote regions (\$664), according to graph 3 (ABS, 2022). As a result, the income gap between regions is approximately \$200. Differences of employment condition between regions showed by graph 4 (ABS, 2016) influence on these income disparities. There is a tendency that employment rates decrease, but unemployment rates increase as regions become more remote.

2.3. Ethics framework of AIATSIS

Impacts and values in this research should be considered in terms of the Australian Institute of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Studies (AIATSIS). The negative impact is a possibility to threat First Nations communities in deciding housing policy. Doyle et al. (2024, p. 4) state public house does often not consider about comprehensive indigenous community from cultural perspective. Thus, it is necessary to consider this problem through investigating their data and traits of their culture. Despite this negative impact, this research give positive impacts on social and economic values. Housing policies can help alleviate poverty by reducing cost burden of house. As a result, this research can be justified by positive impacts on social and economic values.

3. Discussion: 500 words $\pm 10\%$ (450 – 550 words)

3.1. Key findings

There are two key findings regarding to burden of housing price in this dashboard, focusing on rental fees. The first key finding is rent preference when choosing housing tenure type in Australia by graph1. This finding means rental fee is the important factor to affect cost burden for most Australian. Lower income compared to rental costs in remote regions is considered second finding. According to graph2 and graph3, rental fees in indigenous regions have increased insistently, whereas median household income of remote regions shows low increase rate compared to non-remote regions. There is also a tendency to have low income toward more remote regions. Moreover, low employment rates in remote regions emerge compared to major cities by graph4. This employment conditions can connect with household income. This unemployment conditions in remote regions increase disparities of household incomes by regions. This income gap between regions may lead to widen social and economic disparities.

There are two main limitations about data utilised in this dashboard. Firstly, datasets in dashboard are provided only through ABS. This limitation can make informal housing conditions excluded because ABS has provided only formal housing information. It is important to consider unique cultural houses of First Nations in Australia. Furthermore, dataset in graph4 can utilise information of employment only in 2016. Therefore, this limitation can affect data reliability due to shortage of recent data. To overcome these limitations, it is necessary to update additional data and collect data from various institutions, such as indigenous communities.

3.2. Recommendations

The two key recommendations have been suggested to help policy-makers plan housing policy. The first recommendation is to provide appropriate form of public housing for reducing housing cost burden. Public housing is the immediate solution for individuals who have difficulty to satisfy housing affordability by poverty. Recently, many social housing's tenants who have low income experience financial stress by unexpected bills (Freund et al., 2022, p. 587). Furthermore, 21% of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander have lived in social housing and they need to obtain the support to improve their wellbeing reflecting their culture (Freund et al., 2022, p. 588). Therefore, policy-makers should consider accurate rules and supports of public housing for residents' wellbeing, including financial standards and living supports. It is secondly recommended that government support for activation of local infrastructure, especially remote regions. This infrastructure can help not only improve vulnerable local environment but also enhance employment rate and household income. According to Memmott et al. (2022, p. 259), the lack of essential infrastructure and services can deteriorate living conditions for residents. The equitable levels of services are demanded for aboriginal people, such as housing, education and health services. Activation of infrastructure may also improve accessibility in remote areas, because an increase in workplace and convenient access to hospital by developing infrastructure can improve mobility of people in remote regions (Memmott et al., 2022, p. 262). Therefore, in the long term, policy to activate infrastructure can improve vulnerable environments and enhance accessibility in remote areas.

4. Conclusion: 300 words $\pm 10\%$ (270 – 330 words)

This report has highlighted the significance to tackle housing challenges in remote regions by adjusting housing affordability and accessibility. To reduce socio-economic inequality and ensure the quality of life for the public, these housing challenges should be solved essentially. This report has analysed the current housing cost situations through datasets in ABS, and has mainly addressed higher housing cost issues. There are two main findings in this analysis. Firstly, the main way to live in house is renting in Australia and rental fees have increased steadily every year. Although rental fees have continuously increased, low median household income and employment rate in remote areas are shown compared to non-remote areas. These situations can deteriorate social and economic inequality between remote regions and non-remote regions, widening wealth disparities.

To solve these challenges in indigenous-majority regions, two primary recommendations can be suggested for policy maker. The first recommendation is the public housing for ensuring housing affordability for individuals who have financial issues. It is important to establish culturally appropriate housing conditions for indigenous communities' wellbeing. Furthermore, additional unexpected bills need to be addressed carefully because financial stress can lead to health problems. As a result, the proper form of public housing should be planned to ensure housing affordability and wellbeing. Secondly, the activation of local infrastructure in remote regions has been suggested to improve housing accessibility and living conditions in the long term. This suggestion can provide new workplaces and improve vulnerable living environments by providing healthcare, education and housing service. In conclusion, policy-makers should recognise the significance of housing challenges and current housing situations through continuous analysis. The policy-makers also need to plan housing policies to improve affordability and accessibility, including public housing and the activation of infrastructure in remote regions.

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